

PATH

1. Passage anchor

> “...because everyone has to find their own **path**.”

Passage meaning

path = a way of living, developing, or moving toward a future goal

道路；**方向**；**人生道路**

Here, **path** is metaphorical.

find your own path

= discover a personal way of living, developing, or making decisions

找到屬於自己的人生道路 / 發展方向

Practice

1. It took her years to find the **path** that suited her best.

她花了好幾年才找到最適合自己的**人生道路**。

2. Everyone follows a different **path** in life.

每個人在人生中都走著不同的**道路**。

Core meanings of PATH

2. path — a track or way for walking

= a narrow route or track that people walk along

小路；**步道**；**路徑**

Examples

1. We followed a narrow **path** through the forest.

我們沿著森林裡一條狹窄的**小路**前進。

2. The **path** leads to the lake.

這條**步道**通往湖邊。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. footpath / walking path

= a path intended mainly for pedestrians

****人行步道；步行小徑****

Examples

1. Cyclists are not allowed on the ****footpath****.

自行車不得進入****人行步道****。

2. A walking ****path**** runs along the river.

河邊有一條****步行小徑****。

4. garden path

= a path through a garden

****花園小徑****

Examples

1. Stone ****paths**** connect the different parts of the garden.

石造****小徑****連接花園的不同區域。

2. She walked slowly along the ****garden path****.

她沿著****花園小徑****慢慢走。

Route / direction

5. path — route from one place to another

= a route or course followed by a person, object, or movement

****路線；路徑****

Examples

1. The storm changed its ****path****.

暴風雨改變了它的****路徑****。

2. The satellite follows a fixed ****path****.

衛星沿著固定****軌跡****運行。

This is broader than a physical walking trail.

6. flight path

= route followed by an aircraft

****飛行路徑；航線****

Examples

1. The plane changed its ****flight path****.
飛機改變了****飛行路徑****。
2. The building lies under a major ****flight path****.
那棟建築位於主要****航線****下方。

7. path of something

= route or line along which something moves

****.....的路徑；.....經過的路線****

Examples

1. The town lay directly in the ****path of the storm****.
那座城鎮正好位於暴風雨的****行進路徑上****。
2. Trees blocked the ****path of the vehicle****.
樹木擋住了車輛的****行進路線****。

Direction of development

8. path — course of development

= the way a situation, process, or person develops over time

****發展道路；發展方向****

Examples

1. The company is on a new ****path of growth****.
公司正走上一條新的****成長道路****。
2. The country followed a different economic ****path****.

那個國家走上了不同的經濟**發展道路**。

This is a major figurative sense.

9. career path

= sequence of jobs, roles, or stages in a person's professional development

職涯道路；職業發展路徑

Examples

1. She chose a different **career path**.

她選擇了不同的**職涯道路**。

2. The course can open up new **career paths**.

這門課可以開啟新的**職業發展方向**。

Very common.

10. educational path

= route or sequence of study and learning choices

求學道路；教育路徑

Examples

1. Students follow different **educational paths**.

學生會走不同的**求學道路**。

2. Her **educational path** was not straightforward.

她的**求學歷程**並不完全順利。

Life direction

11. path in life

= direction or course someone takes in their life

人生道路；人生方向

Examples

1. He was unsure which **path in life** to choose.

他不確定該選擇哪一條**人生道路**。

2. Everyone's **path in life** is different.

每個人的**人生道路**都不同。

This is very close to the passage use.

12. your own path

= your personal way of living, choosing, and developing

自己的道路；屬於自己的方向

Examples

1. You should learn from others but still follow **your own path**.

你應該向別人學習，但仍要走**自己的路**。

2. She eventually found **her own path**.

她最後找到了**屬於自己的方向**。

Exact passage family.

Route toward a goal

13. path to something

= way or process that can lead to a goal or outcome

通往.....的道路；達成.....的方法

Examples

1. Education can be a **path to opportunity**.

教育可以是通往機會的**道路**。

2. There is no single **path to success**.

通往成功並沒有唯一的一條**道路**。

14. path to success

= route or process through which success may be achieved

****成功之路****

Examples

1. Hard work alone is not always the only ****path to success****.
努力並不一定是唯一的****成功之路****。
2. She found her own ****path to success****.
她找到了自己的****成功道路****。

15. path to recovery

= process leading toward recovery

****康復之路；復原道路****

Examples

1. Asking for help was the first step on his ****path to recovery****.
尋求幫助是他踏上****康復之路****的第一步。
2. She is slowly moving along the ****path to recovery****.
她正在慢慢走上****復原之路****。

Course of action

16. path — course of action or decision

= a particular way of proceeding or making choices

****做法；路線；方針****

Examples

1. The team chose a more cautious ****path****.
團隊選擇了較謹慎的****路線****。
2. We need to decide which ****path**** to take.
我們需要決定要採取哪條****路線 / 做法****。

17. take a path

= choose or follow a particular direction or course

****走上一條路；採取一種方向****

Examples

1. She decided to ****take a different path****.
她決定****走一條不同的路****。
2. The company ****took a more conservative path****.
公司採取了較保守的****發展路線****。

Literal obstruction / access

18. block someone's path

= physically prevent someone from moving forward

****擋住某人的路****

Examples

1. A fallen tree ****blocked our path****.
一棵倒下的樹****擋住了我們的路****。
2. He stood in the doorway and ****blocked her path****.
他站在門口，****擋住了她的去路****。

19. clear a path

= remove obstacles so movement becomes possible

****清出道路；開路****

Examples

1. Workers ****cleared a path**** through the snow.
工人們在雪中****清出一條路****。
2. They ****cleared a path**** for the ambulance.
他們為救護車****讓出一條路****。

20. cross someone's path

A. literally cross the route someone is taking

****橫越某人的路線****

B. figuratively meet someone, often unexpectedly

****與某人相遇；碰上某人****

Examples

1. A deer suddenly ****crossed our path****.

一隻鹿突然****從我們面前穿過****。

2. I never expected our ****paths to cross again****.

我從沒想到我們的人生道路還會再次****交會****。

Figurative overlap/intersection

21. paths cross

= two people meet, often unexpectedly

****道路交會；偶然相遇****

Examples

1. Our ****paths first crossed**** at university.

我們第一次****相遇****是在大學。

2. I hope our ****paths cross again**** someday.

希望我們有一天能再次****相遇****。

Very common figurative expression.

22. go separate ways / paths diverge

= people begin following different directions in life

****分道揚鑣；走上不同道路****

Examples

1. After graduation, their **paths diverged**.

畢業後，他們走上了不同的**人生道路**。

2. Eventually, the two friends followed separate **paths**.

最後，兩位朋友走上了不同的**道路**。

Technology / computing

23. path — location route in a file system

= a sequence showing where a file or folder is located within a computer system

路徑；**檔案路徑**

Examples

1. Check the file **path**.

檢查**檔案路徑**。

2. The program could not find the specified **path**.

程式找不到指定的**路徑**。

A major technical sense.

24. file path

= exact location of a file in a directory system

檔案路徑

Examples

1. Copy the full **file path**.

複製完整的**檔案路徑**。

2. The **file path** contains the folder name.

檔案路徑包含資料夾名稱。

25. network path

= location or route used to access a resource over a network

****網路路徑****

Examples

1. The shared folder has a new ****network path****.
共用資料夾有新的****網路路徑****。
2. Check whether the ****network path**** is available.
檢查該****網路路徑****是否可用。

Mathematics / graphs / systems

26. path — sequence connecting points or nodes

= a route through a network, graph, or system from one point to another
****路徑****

Examples

1. The algorithm searches for the shortest ****path****.
演算法會搜尋最短****路徑****。
2. Several possible ****paths**** connect the two nodes.
兩個節點之間有多條可能的****路徑****。

Technical but very common in computing/mathematics.

27. shortest path

= route with minimum distance/cost between points
****最短路徑****

Examples

1. The software calculates the ****shortest path****.
軟體會計算****最短路徑****。
2. The problem asks for the ****shortest path between two nodes****.
這個問題要求找出兩個節點之間的****最短路徑****。

Physics / motion

28. path — trajectory

= line or course followed by a moving object

****運動路徑；軌跡****

Examples

1. Scientists tracked the ****path of the particle****.

科學家追蹤粒子的****運動軌跡****。

2. The ball followed a curved ****path****.

球沿著一條彎曲的****軌跡****移動。

Common expressions

29. on the path to something

= progressing toward a particular result

****走在通往.....的道路上****

Examples

1. She is on the ****path to becoming a doctor****.

她正走在****成為醫生的道路上****。

2. The company is on the ****path to recovery****.

公司正走在****復甦的道路上****。

30. set someone on a path

= cause someone to begin developing or moving in a certain direction

****使某人走上某條道路****

Examples

1. That teacher ****set me on the path to teaching****.

那位老師使我****走上了教學這條路****。

2. One opportunity ****set her on a new career path****.

一次機會讓她****走上了新的職涯道路****。

Highly relevant to the passage's influence theme.

31. stay on the right path

= continue behaving or developing in a good or appropriate direction

****繼續走在正確道路上****

Examples

1. His mentor helped him ****stay on the right path****.

他的導師幫助他****繼續走在正確的道路上****。

2. Good habits can keep you ****on the right path****.

良好習慣可以讓你****維持在正確方向上****。

32. go down a path

= begin following a course of action or development

****走上一條路；採取某種路線****

Examples

1. I don't want to ****go down that path**** again.

我不想再次****走上那條路****。

2. The discussion was beginning to ****go down a different path****.

討論開始****朝另一個方向發展****。

Very common figurative use.

33. path of least resistance

= easiest course of action, requiring the least effort or conflict

****阻力最小的道路；最省事的做法****

Examples

1. He usually chooses the ****path of least resistance****.

他通常會選擇****最省力的做法****。

2. The easiest option is not always the best **path**.

最容易的選項不一定是最好的**道路**。

34. beaten path

= commonly used route; figuratively, conventional way of doing things

常走的路；慣常做法

Examples

1. We left the **beaten path** and explored a quieter area.

我們離開了**常走的路線**，探索較安靜的區域。

2. She preferred to work outside the **beaten path**.

她比較喜歡走**非傳統路線**。

More commonly appears in **off the beaten path**.

35. off the beaten path

A. away from commonly travelled places

偏僻的；不在熱門路線上

B. unconventional

非傳統的；與眾不同的

Examples

1. We found a café **off the beaten path**.

我們找到一家**不在熱門路線上的**咖啡館。

2. His career has followed a route **off the beaten path**.

他的職涯走的是一條**非傳統路線**。

Related forms / compounds

36. pathway

= path, route, or sequence leading toward an outcome

****路徑；途徑****

Examples

1. The programme provides a ****pathway to employment****.

這個計畫提供一條****就業途徑****。

2. Researchers studied the biological ****pathway**** involved.

研究人員研究了相關的生物****途徑****。

****Pathway**** is especially common in:

* education

* careers

* biology

* medicine

37. career pathway

= structured route toward a career or professional level

****職涯路徑****

Examples

1. The course offers a clear ****career pathway****.

這門課提供清楚的****職涯路徑****。

2. Students explored several possible ****career pathways****.

學生探索了幾種可能的****職涯發展方向****。

38. pathway — biological process

= linked sequence of biochemical reactions or biological processes

****生物途徑；代謝途徑****

Examples

1. The drug affects a specific biological ****pathway****.

這種藥物會影響特定的生物****途徑****。

2. Researchers identified a signaling **pathway**.

研究人員找出了一條訊息傳遞**途徑**。

Technical family extension.

Key contrasts

39. path vs road

road

= constructed route for vehicles and travel

道路；公路

path

= narrower route, often for walking; also much more productive figuratively

小路；路徑；人生道路

Compare:

> The car turned onto a narrow **road**.

> 車子轉進一條狹窄道路。

> We followed a forest **path**.

> 我們沿著森林小徑走。

40. path vs route

route

= planned or established way from one location to another

路線

path

= exact course followed, or a figurative course of development

路徑；道路

Compare:

> This bus **route** goes downtown.

> 這條公車路線通往市中心。

> The storm's **path** moved east.

> 暴風雨的行進路徑向東移動。

41. path vs way

way is much broader and can mean:

- * route
- * method
- * manner
- * direction

path more strongly evokes:

- * a route to follow
- * a sequence of development
- * a life direction

Compare:

- > Find a **way** to solve the problem.
- > 找到解決問題的方法。

- > Find your own **path** in life.
- > 找到自己的人生道路。

42. path vs direction

direction
= general orientation or course
方向

path
= the actual route/course followed through that direction
路徑；道路

Compare:

- > I know the general **direction**.
- > 我知道大概方向。

- > I don't know which **path** to take.
- > 我不知道該走哪條路。

43. path vs journey

****path****

= route or course

****journey****

= process or experience of travelling along that route

****旅程；歷程****

Compare:

> Her career ****path**** changed.

> 她的職涯道路改變了。

> Her career ****journey**** was full of unexpected turns.

> 她的職涯****歷程****充滿意外轉折。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****path**** is:

****a route that can be followed from one point toward another****

From this develop:

Physical route

forest path

→ ****小路；步道****

Movement

path of a storm

→ ****路徑；軌跡****

Personal development

life path

→ ****人生道路****

Professional development

career path

→ **職涯道路**

Goal

path to success

→ **通往成功的道路**

Course of action

choose a path

→ **採取某種路線**

Computing

file path

→ **檔案路徑**

Networks/mathematics

shortest path

→ **最短路徑**

The passage metaphor is therefore very direct:

a physical path guides your movement through space

→ **a life path guides your development through choices and experiences**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
path — walking route	供人步行的狹窄道路、小徑或步道
path — route/course	某人、物體或現象實際移動所經過的路線 / 路徑
path of a storm/object	某個移動事物所經過的行進路徑或軌跡
path — development	某人、組織或事物長期發展所走的道路 / 方向
career path	一個人在職業生涯中所經歷或選擇的發展道路
life path / path in life	一個人生活、成長與作選擇所走的人生道路
your own path	根據自己的價值、情況與選擇形成的個人發展方向
path to + goal/result	通往某個目標或結果的方法 / 發展道路
take/choose a path	選擇並開始採取某種行動或發展方向
block someone's path	擋住某人前進的路
clear a path	移除障礙，讓人或物可以通過
paths cross	字面路線交叉；比喻兩人偶然相遇

path — file system	顯示電腦中檔案 / 資料夾位置的路徑	
path — network/graph	連接系統中不同節點的一連串路線	
path — trajectory	移動物體所形成的運動路徑 / 軌跡	
set someone on a path	使某人開始朝某個人生、職涯或發展方向前進	
on the path to...	正逐步朝某個結果或目標前進	
go down a path	開始採取某種行動方式或發展方向	
path of least resistance	最容易、阻力最小的處理方式	
off the beaten path	不在常見路線上；比喻非傳統、較少人採取的方向	
pathway	通往某個結果的途徑；特別常見於教育、職涯與生物學	

Passage recap

> “...because everyone has to ****find their own path****.”

Here:

****path**** = ****a personal way of living, developing, and making choices****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****自己的人生道路****

* ****自己的方向****

* ****適合自己的發展道路****

Natural contextual translation:

****每個人終究都要找到屬於自己的人生道路。 ****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****path**** in ****“find their own path”****

= ****a personal course or direction in life****

****人生道路；發展方向；自己的路****

It is not a literal walking path here, though the metaphor comes directly from the image of ****choosing and following a route toward where you want to go****.